

Deserts

It hardly ever rains in the deserts, so the animals that live there have to survive without drinking for long periods or get all the water they need from their food. They also have to cope with boiling-hot days and freezing-cold nights. Many animals come out only at dawn and dusk when it is cooler and more humid.

Find out more: pages 14–15, 34–35, 44–45, 52–53.

Rainforests

Rainforests grow near the equator, where the weather is warm and humid year round. Most of the trees are evergreen with broad leaves. Rainforests contain the richest variety of wildlife to be found anywhere on Earth. More than 50 percent of all the different kinds of plants and animals in the world live in the rainforests.

Find out more: pages 24–25, 36–37, 54–55.

Marshes and swamp

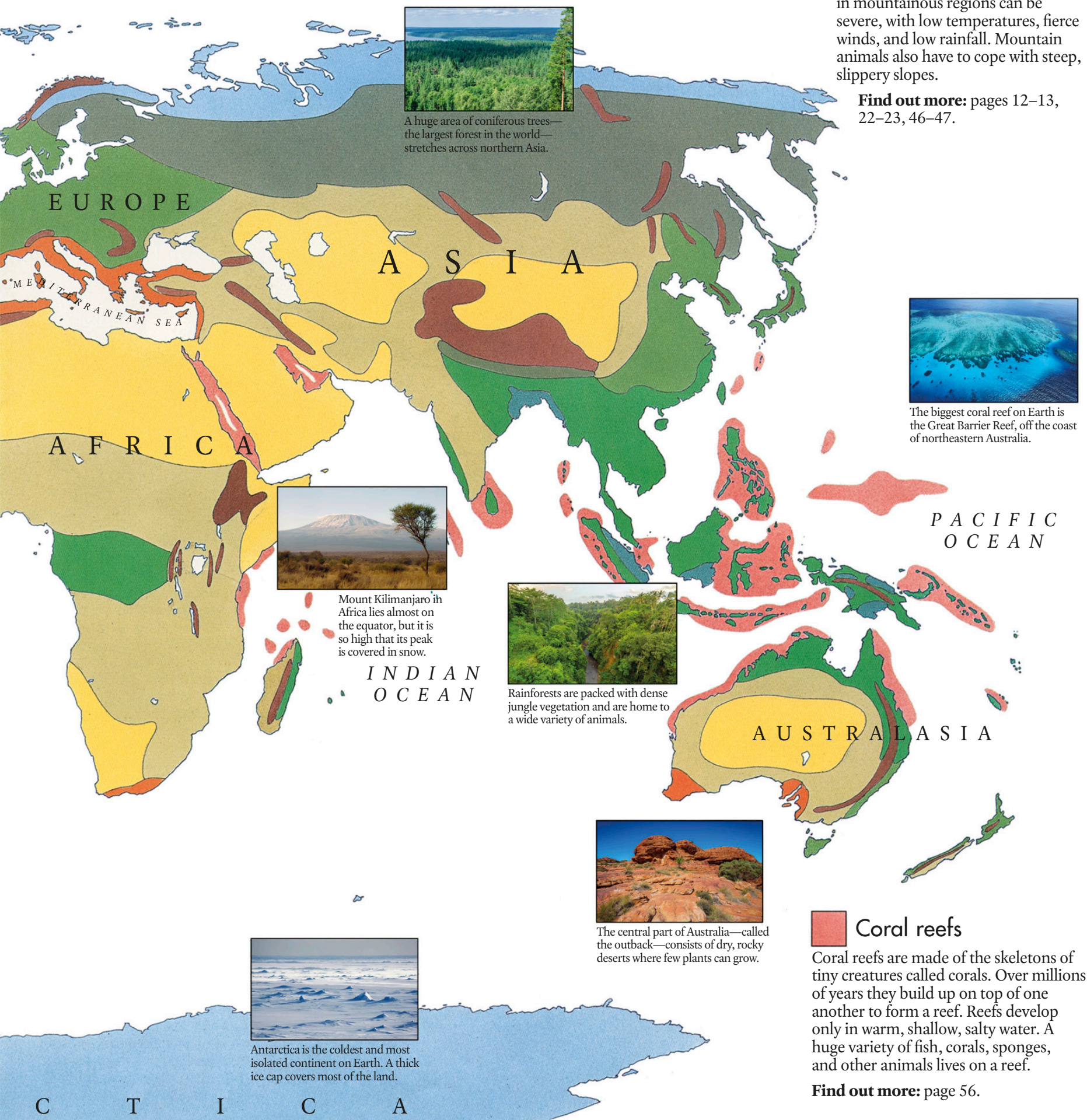
Marshy, waterlogged places develop near lakes and rivers and along coasts. One of the largest marshland areas is the Everglades in Florida. Mangrove swamps often fringe the coasts in tropical areas. Both these habitats are rich in food supplies and places to breed, and provide homes for a wide variety of animals, especially birds and insects.

Find out more: pages 16–17.

Mountains

Mountains are found in both warm and cold regions of the world. They provide a wide range of habitats for wildlife, from forests on the lower slopes to grassland and tundra farther up. The higher up you go, the colder it becomes. Above a certain height—called the tree line—the temperature is too low for trees to survive. Even higher up is the snow line. Above this it is so cold that the ground is always covered in snow and ice. The climate in mountainous regions can be severe, with low temperatures, fierce winds, and low rainfall. Mountain animals also have to cope with steep, slippery slopes.

Find out more: pages 12–13, 22–23, 46–47.



Coral reefs

Coral reefs are made of the skeletons of tiny creatures called corals. Over millions of years they build up on top of one another to form a reef. Reefs develop only in warm, shallow, salty water. A huge variety of fish, corals, sponges, and other animals lives on a reef.

Find out more: page 56.